



Above The Temple of the Emerald Buddha, in the compound of the Grand Palace in Bangkok

A Day in Bangkok

Take advantage of the cool of the morning for a walking tour of the cultural center, then use the river as an “expressway” to other sights.

MORNING Start the day in **Ko Ratanakosin**, which rests in a bend of the **Chao Phraya River** and contains some of the city’s most historic architecture. **Wat Pho** is Bangkok’s oldest temple and home to one of the largest reclining Buddha statues in the world. The nearby **Grand Palace** has been superseded by Chitlada Palace as the primary royal residence, but it is still used for ceremonial occasions. Adjacent **Wat Phra Kaew**, home to the “Emerald Buddha” (actually jade), is a gleaming example of Bangkok temple architecture at its most baroque.

AFTERNOON Catch a ferry across the river to **Supatra River House** to sample some great *tom yam*. From Chang pier, rent a long-tailed boat for a two-hour tour through **Thonburi**’s extensive canal network, admiring the old wooden houses and floating vendors.

EVENING Cool off by quaffing a cold beer and sampling more foodie treats at the **Soi 38 Night Market**, off Sukhumvit.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Suvarnabhumi International Airport is 18 miles (30 km) from Bangkok; “Airport Express” **buses** and **taxis** go downtown.

WHERE TO STAY

Phra-Nakorn Norn-Len (inexpensive) is a trendy hotel with pretty, affordable accommodations in a quiet part of Bangkok near the river.

www.phranakorn-nornlen.com

Conrad Bangkok (moderate) is conveniently located downtown near the BTS Sukhumvit line and shopping centers.

<http://conradhotels1.hilton.com>

Chakrabongse Villas (expensive) are exquisite riverfront villas in the grounds of a century-old Thai palace. www.thaivillas.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

www.bangkoktourist.com



Above Bangkok has many night markets, full of chattering locals and tourists eating, drinking, and shopping until late